HACK876 × BRITISH COUNCIL JAMAICA

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Every classroom needs a day to build.

The British Council is helping Jamaican teachers bring creativity and computational thinking into class. Hack876 gives secondary-school students one day to show what that looks like in their own hands.

Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)



80	9	1
STUDENTS	SCHOOL NETWORK	DAY

ONE DAY TO BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

Meet Hack876.



Hack876 is a one-day build competition for approximately **80 secondary-school students** from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4, roughly 20 teams in all, on Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative).

Teams pick a real problem, use modern tools including AI, get guidance from mentors, and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges. It is not a school assignment and there is no answer key.

Our **9-school network** in Kingston is made up of the schools where the Hack876 team currently has relationships and can coordinate most reliably. It is not an exclusive eligibility list.

BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

Why the British Council

Hack876 is a day where STEAM stops being a subject and becomes something young people make together.

THE BRITISH COUNCIL'S PURPOSE

"We support peace and prosperity by building connections, understanding and trust between people in the UK and countries worldwide."[2]

STEAM Education in Schools Jamaica runs from November 2024 to October 2027 and aims to train 10,770 teachers and benefit 328,500 students.[3]

The programme names Codefest and STEAM Challenges as ways to actively engage students.[3]

It deliberately builds in creativity, the 'A' in STEAM, to give students more than one way into learning.[3]

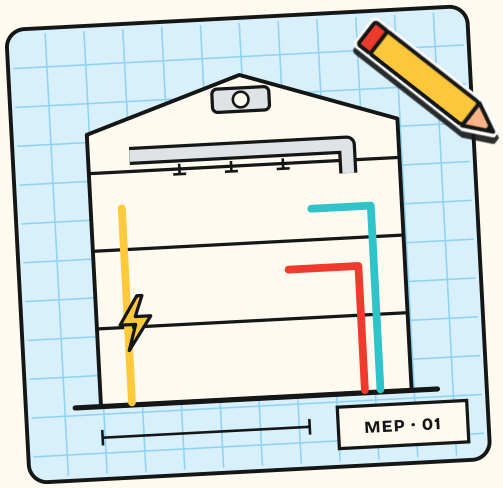
In January 2026 the British Council partnered with the National Education Trust on the STEAM in Action Expo, where students showcased projects from robotics to climate solutions.[1]

Damion Campbell has said the STEAM partnership lets the Council "connect more young people in the UK with Jamaica to share their experiences, expertise".[4]

A STEAM partnership, built step by step.

2020	Cooperation between the UK and Jamaica on STEAM education begins to develop.[5]
2022	The British Council commissions the National STEAM Education Report with NET and the UK-based STEMunity.[6]
2023	Jamaica and the British Council sign a five-year partnership on STEAM education.[4]
2025	A GB£1.7 million STEAM Education in Schools programme launches for more than 800 primary and secondary institutions.[7]
2026	Students show their projects at the STEAM in Action Expo, held in partnership with the British Council.[1]
2027	The programme is set to run to October 2027.[3]

The programme was built to reach classrooms. Hack876 is one more place students can show what reached them.



9 schools. One room.

Hack876 begins with the schools where we already have relationships and can coordinate most reliably for the inaugural staging. Formal confirmations are still in progress, and the network is not an exclusive eligibility list.

- Hillel Academy
- Campion College
- Jamaica College
- Immaculate Conception High School
- Wolmer's
- Ardenne High School
- American International School of Kingston
- St. Andrew High School for Girls
- St. George's College

There are two natural homes for this inside the British Council.

EDUCATION

Through the STEAM programme

- Help us invite programme-trained teachers to mentor teams.
- Share what works from Codefest and STEAM Challenges.
- A short talk on where STEAM can lead.

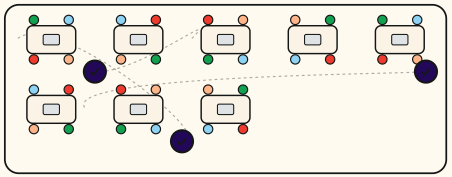
CONNECTION

Through UK and Jamaica links

- Introductions to UK STEAM practitioners.
- Remote judging or mentoring on the day.
- A UK perspective on what students build.
- A first step toward a youth exchange element.

The British Council's contribution does not have to be purely financial.

People in the room.



01
Mentor teachers

Programme-trained teachers moving between teams, helping students test ideas and get unstuck.

02
Opening speaker

A few minutes on why creativity and problem-solving matter, from someone who works on it every day.

03
Remote judges

UK STEAM practitioners joining by video to see demos and ask good questions.

04
Challenge advisers

Help shaping a creativity-led challenge that fits the spirit of the 'A' in STEAM.

05
Observers

Programme staff seeing first-hand what secondary students do with a day, a team and a problem.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

Many participants are minors. Adults work with teams in open, supervised spaces, never one to one, and follow our safeguarding plan.

We do not share student contact details or personal data with partners, and we never ask partners to collect any.

No marketing to students. Recognition lives on our materials, not in students' inboxes.

Support the inaugural Hack876 in kind.

In kind

IN-KIND PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876

The British Council works through people and partnerships, so that is our ask: teachers, know-how and a UK connection, not a cheque. A named award is entirely optional.

- Help inviting STEAM-trained teachers from the programme to mentor teams, where appropriate.
- A British Council speaker on STEAM, creativity and global pathways.
- Advice on shaping a creativity challenge, drawing on Codefest and STEAM Challenge experience.
- Introductions to UK STEAM practitioners who could judge or mentor remotely.
- Sharing the call for applications with programme teachers in our schools.

PROPOSED RECOGNITION

British Council Jamaica

In-kind Partner · Inaugural Hack876

Closest Hack876 tracks: Learn, Culture, Resilience

No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

WHAT A CONTRIBUTION COULD SUPPORT

- **Programming.** Helps support mentoring, judging and the student programme.

A sponsor can support the event overall, or agree a specific use with the Hack876 team. No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

In-kind & Community Support

For devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and for contributions below J$50,000.

A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

AN IDEA, NOT YET A HACK876 AWARD

STEAM Creativity Award (proposed)

A suggestion only: an award for the build that best brings creativity, the 'A' in STEAM, together with technology. Name and branding would be the British Council's call.

09 A DIRECT LINE

There is no faceless sponsorship process here.

This proposal is for **Damion Campbell, Country Director, British Council**.[1]

If the British Council is interested, we can decide together what involvement should actually look like.

QUESTIONS WE WOULD ANSWER TOGETHER

- ✓ Which schools take part, and are any of them in the STEAM programme?
- ✓ Is this a cost to the British Council, or time and people?
- ✓ How does Hack876 fit the Ministry's STEAM agenda and our programme goals?
- ✓ How are students under 18 safeguarded on the day?
- ✓ How would the British Council be recognised, and what would need approval?
- ✓ When is it, and does it fall inside the programme timeline?

A conversation, not a workload.

Deliberately focused.

Our vision is national. This inaugural staging does not have national-event resources, and we will not pretend it does.

Approximately 80 students. A school network of 9 in Kingston. One day, done properly.

Build the first one well.
Learn from it.
Earn the right to make the second one bigger.

2027

Help make the first Hack876 happen.

No multi-year commitment required.

FUTURE POSSIBILITIES, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

- An annual showcase for students taught by STEAM programme teachers.
- A Codefest-style round in schools that feeds into Hack876.
- UK teams or practitioners joining remotely, building the people-to-people links the partnership talks about.
- Bringing standout Hack876 builds to National STEAM Education Week.



HACK876 × BRITISH COUNCIL JAMAICA

Somewhere in that room may be a future founder, engineer, designer or leader.

They do not need us to decide who they become.

They need an opportunity to begin.

HELP US BUILD THAT OPPORTUNITY.

We would love to explore the right first step with Damion and the British Council team in Jamaica.

Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)

hack876.com info@hack876.com

SOURCES

1. Jamaica Information Service, "NET Executive Director Urges Students to Embrace Critical Thinking (January 30, 2026)." jis.gov.jm/net-executive-director-urges-students-to-embrace-critical-thinking/

2. British Council, "British Council (homepage, purpose statement)." www.britishcouncil.org/

3. British Council, "STEAM Education in Schools Jamaica." caribbean.britishcouncil.org/programmes/education/STEAM-Jamaica

4. Jamaica Information Service, "Jamaica and British Council Sign Five-Year Partnership on STEAM Education (May 22, 2023)." jis.gov.jm/jamaica-and-british-council-sign-five-year-partnership-on-steam-education/

5. Our Today, "National Education Trust partners with British Council to bolster STEAM education (May 20, 2023)." our.today/national-education-trust-partners-with-british-council-to-bolster-steam-education/

6. Jamaica Information Service, "Gov't Strengthening STEAM Education." jis.gov.jm/govt-strengthening-steam-education/

7. Ministry of Education, Skills, Youth and Information, "British Council Launches GB£1.7M Three-Year STEAM Education in Schools Programme (March 21, 2025)." moey.gov.jm/british-council-launches-gb1-7m-three-year-steam-education-in-schools-programme/

A private partnership proposal prepared for Damion Campbell, Country Director, British Council.